



**SCHIAPARELLI**  
*IS IT COUTURE OR IS IT FASHION.*

*Cecil Beaton*





COUTURE AS SURREALISM





## THE STATEMENT CONTINUES

Decades later, the house still speaks in the same surreal vocabulary. Schiaparelli exaggerates form, transforms the body into sculpture, and treats couture as fashion. What has evolved is not the intention, but the scale : fashion became the spectacle, art becomes the wardrobe, and imagination forms the statement.



Schiaparelli, Spring 2022

## THE ORIGIN

Elsa Schiaparelli never treated fashion as decoration. From the beginning, her work belonged to the world of art, surrealism, and provocation. Garments designed not just to be worn, but to be understood. In an era when clothing was expected to follow elegance, Schiaparelli introduced humour, symbolism, and the unexpected. She built a legacy that refused the ordinary, proving that couture could be imagination made physical.

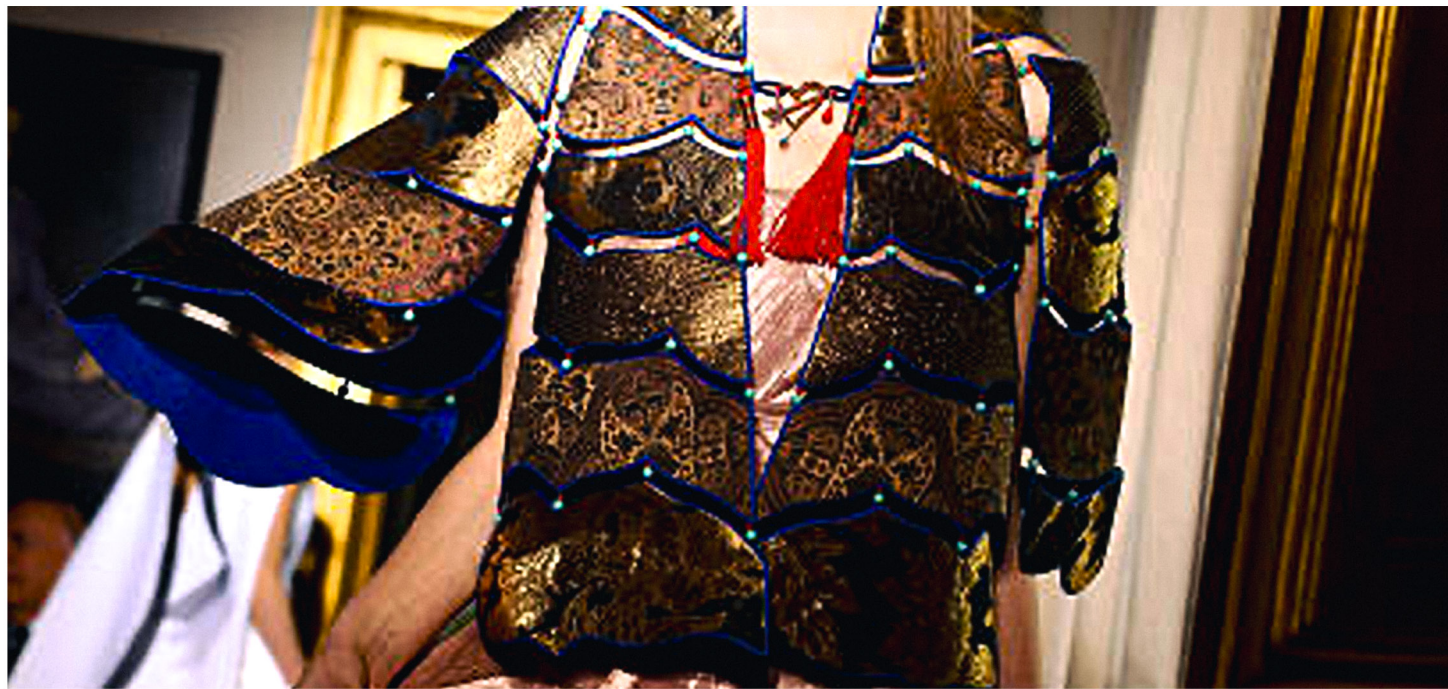




COUTURE DISSECTED  
*SCHIAPARELLI, PARIS FASHION WEEK SS // 2017*



Jacket detail // gold threadwork



Embroidered lapel // Spring 2017



Couture close-up



## SCHIAPARELLI HAUTE COUTURE

*Spring 2017*

An atelier built on illusion: embroidered trompe-l'œil, saturated colour, and surreal motifs that sit between sculpture and dressmaking. In an era increasingly drawn toward restraint, Schiaparelli stands apart holding onto the legacy Elsa began, where couture is not minimal, but deliberate, graphic, and unapologetically theatrical.







At Schiaparelli, identity is built through exaggeration not as excess, but as intention. These elements form a visual language that resists trend and time, where couture operates as expression rather than ornament.



THE VISUAL VOCABULARY  
Paris Fashion Week — Spring/Summer 2014



*Hair becomes architecture. Accessories distort the body. Colour refuses subtlety.*







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“Fashion is born by small facts,  
trends, or even politics, never by  
trying to make little pleats and fur-  
belows, by trinkets, by clothes easy  
to copy, or by the shortening or  
lengthening of a skirt.”

~ Elsa Schiaparelli





# SCHIAPARELLI

*A study in surreal couture*

*Created by Shloka Vikrant  
Editorial design project, 2026*